IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 22, 2026

Blockade Standoff

Trump extends the ceasefire indefinitely while the naval blockade remains; oil retreats from $100 as defensives led Tuesday's selloff and gold tumbled.

S&P 500	BRENT CRUDE	GOLD	BITCOIN	FEAR & GREED
7,041 ↓0.65%	~$98 · Off from $100+ intraday	GLD ↓2.83%	~$74,500 ↓1.7%	32 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets

THE SELLOFF WAS DEFENSIVE-LED — NOT WHAT A CEASEFIRE DAY TYPICALLY LOOKS LIKE

Tuesday's tape inverted the conventional geopolitical playbook. The S&P 500 slipped 0.65% to roughly 7,041, the Dow fell 0.60%, the Nasdaq declined 0.38%, and the Russell 2000 lagged at −1.02%. UVXY rose 2.71%. The leadership was counter-intuitive: Real Estate (−1.93%), Utilities (−1.75%), Industrials (−1.41%), and Communication Services (−1.34%) led declines, while Energy (+1.45%) and Tech (+0.08%) held up. TLT fell 0.55% and the 20-year trade remains under pressure—the bond-proxy sleeves sold off as rate-cut odds for April remained near zero following resilient March inflation and payroll data. The move reads as positioning into higher-for-longer rates rather than a risk-off geopolitical hedge. S&P 500 futures are modestly higher overnight on AI optimism and the ceasefire extension, per Reuters.

DGX AND SYF VALIDATED THE DIVIDEND-SLEEVE THESIS — GPC HELD DESPITE A NARROW MISS

The first IOWN financial and healthcare prints of the cycle delivered. DGX surged 4.45% to $205.04 after reporting Q1 EPS of $2.50 vs. $2.37 consensus and revenue of $2.90 billion (up 9.2% year-over-year), then raising full-year 2026 EPS guidance to $10.63–$10.83 and revenue to $11.78–$11.90 billion. Advanced Diagnostics and Alzheimer's blood-test volumes drove the beat. SYF delivered EPS of $2.27 vs. $2.22 est but closed down 1.21% as the market focused on forward credit-loss trajectory rather than the headline print. GPC reported EPS of $1.77 vs. $1.78 est (a narrow miss) and still gained 2.14% on constructive commentary around inflationary pricing recovery. The through-line: consumer-credit resilience and healthcare volume growth remain intact, which is exactly the read the dividend sleeve was built to provide.

GOLD AND SILVER WERE THE SESSION'S CLEANEST CASUALTY — THE CEASEFIRE-EXTENSION TRADE LANDED HERE

GLD fell 2.83% and SLV collapsed 5.07% on Tuesday as the dollar firmed and news broke that Trump would extend the ceasefire pending Iran's proposal, per Reuters and Axios. The miner sleeve absorbed the full impact: AEM dropped 6.15% and GFI fell 6.58%. Benzinga attributed the precious-metals weakness to Fed-chair-nominee Warsh's hawkish Senate testimony and softening war-premium narratives. The miner selloff contrasts with WTI's 5.71% session rally (USO) — oil rose on ceasefire uncertainty during the cash session before retreating overnight as the extension was confirmed. The

divergence highlights that commodity markets are pricing different pieces of the same event: oil is pricing Hormuz operational risk, while gold is pricing dollar strength and the fading war premium. For IOWN's growth sleeve, the miner drawdown is meaningful — AEM and GFI were among the conflict's best performers and have now given back a substantial portion of the rally.

SEMICONDUCTOR LEADERSHIP HELD — AMD, NXPI, AND KEYS OUTPERFORMED INTO LRCX'S PRINT TODAY

AMD gained 3.47% to $284.49, NXPI added 1.43%, and KEYS rose 1.24% as the semis continued their multi-week recovery despite the broader tape. TSM closed +0.50%. Stifel and Morgan Stanley reset targets ahead of the earnings cycle, per Yahoo. The Amazon-Anthropic $25 billion investment announcement reinforced the AI capex narrative that is powering the group. LRCX (–1.82% to $258.37) reports today after close with consensus around $1.38 EPS on roughly $5.70 billion revenue. The memory capex inflection — HBM3e/4 and advanced packaging — is the read the committee is watching. UBS trimmed QCOM's price target to $150 citing rising memory prices as a chip-stock headwind; LRCX guidance will indicate whether that pressure is pricing demand or simply shifting margin capture across the supply chain.

S&P 500	7,041 · ↓0.65% · Defensive-led selloff
SECTOR LEADERS	Energy +1.45% · Tech +0.08%
SECTOR LAGGARDS	Real Estate –1.93% · Utilities –1.75% · Industrials –1.41%
DGX	$205.04 · ↑4.45% · Q1 beat + 2026 guidance raised
GOLD / SILVER	GLD ↓2.83% · SLV ↓5.07% · Miners down 6%+
CARSON'S SPY SUPPORT	$645.80 · Untouched · ~8% below current

A defensive-led selloff on a ceasefire day is the kind of rotation that reveals what the market actually cares about right now: rates, not war. With April FOMC priced as a hold and one cut still the baseline for 2026 per Polymarket, the duration trade has lost its ballast. **The physical world matters.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

TRUMP EXTENDED THE CEASEFIRE — BUT THE BLOCKADE STAYED, AND IRAN WALKED

Late Tuesday, Trump reversed his Monday posture and announced an indefinite extension of the ceasefire at the request of Pakistani mediators, to remain in place until Iran submits a comprehensive proposal to end the war, per Al Jazeera and Axios. The extension, however, preserves the US naval blockade on Iranian ports. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi characterized the continued blockade as an act of war and a violation of the ceasefire, per Al Jazeera, and indicated Tehran would not negotiate while under coercive pressure. Vice President Vance's scheduled Islamabad trip was cancelled, per CBS News. The architecture is a managed pause rather than an off-ramp: the shooting has stopped, the economic coercion continues, and the diplomatic track is in limbo. That structure is precisely what oil markets are pricing — Brent retreated overnight to approximately $98 after briefly breaching $100 intraday Tuesday, per CNBC.

UK INFLATION JUMPED TO 3.3% — THE FIRST CLEAN IRAN-WAR DATA PRINT

UK CPI accelerated to 3.3% year-over-year, which Reuters characterized as showing the first material second-order effects of the Iran war on developed-market inflation. The release is the first clean data point connecting the conflict's energy-supply disruption to a consumer price index outside the US. March US CPI already printed at 3.3% with gasoline up 21.2%; the UK print confirms the inflation leg of the conflict is now global, not regional. The implication for IOWN's thesis is direct: the structural cost-push pressures underpinning the dividend sleeve's pricing-power names (GPC, CL, CHD) and the energy sleeve (CVX, VLO, OKE) are visible in incoming data across the G7. This is why the rate-cut path has narrowed even as growth expectations have softened — central banks globally are now navigating an inflation regime that they did not forecast entering the year.

THE WARSH CONFIRMATION ADDED A SECOND FED-INDEPENDENCE DATA POINT

Fed-chair nominee Kevin Warsh testified Tuesday that the president had never asked him to commit in advance to any interest-rate decision, and he rejected the suggestion that he would serve as a compliant partisan instrument, per CNN and CNBC. Warsh also pitched a framework overhaul that would reduce FOMC meeting frequency and revisit the inflation-targeting regime. Sen. Thom Tillis indicated he would block the nomination in committee pending the Powell investigation, which matters because Republicans hold a 12–10 advantage on Banking — one dissent stalls the process. The hearing pressured gold and duration assets (GLD −2.83%, TLT −0.55%, miners down 6%+) as the market read the testimony as directionally hawkish relative to the political pressure Warsh would face. The committee's durable read: Fed independence remains contested, but the transition path is now longer and more uncertain than the market had priced coming into April.

CEASEFIRE	Extended indefinitely · Blockade remains (Al Jazeera)
IRAN POSITION	Blockade framed as act of war · Will not negotiate under coercion
VANCE TRIP	Islamabad talks cancelled (CBS News)
BRENT OVERNIGHT	~$98 · Retreated from $100+ intraday (CNBC)
UK CPI	3.3% YoY · First Iran-war inflation print (Reuters)
WARSH HEARING	Tillis may block in committee · Republicans hold 12–10

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. LRCX reports today after close — the cleanest read on AI memory capex. Consensus is centered on EPS near $1.38 on revenue of approximately $5.70 billion, per MarketBeat and Nasdaq compilations. Lam's March guide was $5.7B ±$300M with EPS $1.35 ±$0.10. The key incremental read is HBM3e/4 demand and advanced-packaging commentary — Lam has guided >40% growth in advanced packaging for 2026 per prior calls. UBS's QCOM target trim on memory-price pressure frames the alternative scenario: if DRAM capex is slowing, LRCX's forward book would signal it here first. The print will inform the entire IOWN semiconductor complex (QCOM, NXPI, ADI, NVDA, AMD, TSM, KEYS). *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. TEL reports today and sits in the AI-connectivity sleeve. TE Connectivity is positioned at the intersection of data-center buildout, industrial automation, and the physical infrastructure that powers AI deployment. The stock closed −1.81% at $243.18 into the print. Yahoo coverage has highlighted TEL as a beneficiary of AI energy demand and the data-center-connectivity cycle. A constructive print would strengthen the physical-AI-infrastructure thesis that sits behind IOWN's tech positioning; a miss on book-to-bill or industrial softness would flag a different read. Tesla also reports after close — not an IOWN holding, but the guidance will move the tape. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. The COIN lawsuit spread to the full crypto-equity complex. New York's Attorney General sued Coinbase and Gemini Tuesday, alleging their prediction-market products constitute unlicensed gambling and seeking disgorgement of profits, civil penalties, and customer restitution, per CNBC and CoinDesk. COIN fell 7.41% to $195.95. HOOD absorbed the contagion at −5.31% despite not being named. NY joins Nevada, Washington, Illinois, Connecticut, Michigan, and Massachusetts in the state-level challenge. For IOWN's digital-asset exposure, the case is narrow — it targets prediction markets, not spot crypto or ETF custody — but the broader regulatory perimeter around exchange business models has widened. IBIT and ETHA are structurally insulated from this specific challenge, though the regulatory overhang can still pressure the group. *Avoid Erosion.*

4. EIA crude inventories arrive at 10:30 AM ET with a draw consensus of approximately 1 million barrels. With oil whipsawing between the blockade standoff and the ceasefire-extension trade, today's print arrives with elevated sensitivity. The prior week showed a draw of 0.9 million barrels. A larger-than-expected draw would reinforce the supply-tight narrative that VLO, CVX, and OKE depend on; a build would suggest demand destruction is finally matching the supply disruption. VLO gained 3.14% Tuesday and has been a bellwether of the energy sleeve's directional read. *The physical world matters.*

5. The miner drawdown is the cleanest reversal signal of the week. AEM −6.15%, GFI −6.58%, alongside GLD −2.83% and SLV −5.07%, reflect a coordinated repricing of the war-premium trade. The precious-metals sleeve had been one of the conflict's best performers; a day like Tuesday does not invalidate the thesis but does mark a regime transition in how the market is pricing the conflict. If Brent stabilizes below $100 and the ceasefire holds even with the blockade in place, miners could face continued pressure. The broader question: with the war premium partially unwound and the rate-cut path narrowed, the two pillars that supported precious metals through Q1 have both softened. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

6. HRMY +8.84% and STLD +5.19% were the session's standouts beyond earnings winners. Harmony Biosciences moved on late-day after-hours health-care flow per Benzinga; STLD continued the post-earnings rally from last week on steel-pricing tailwinds and infrastructure demand. The divergence from the broader tape — industrial and healthcare names outperforming on idiosyncratic catalysts while the sector ETFs (XLI −1.41%, XLV −1.02%) declined — reinforces the narrow-leadership dynamic that has characterized the April tape. Sector ETFs are not capturing the dispersion that bottom-up selection is finding this cycle. **Think Like an Owner.**

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